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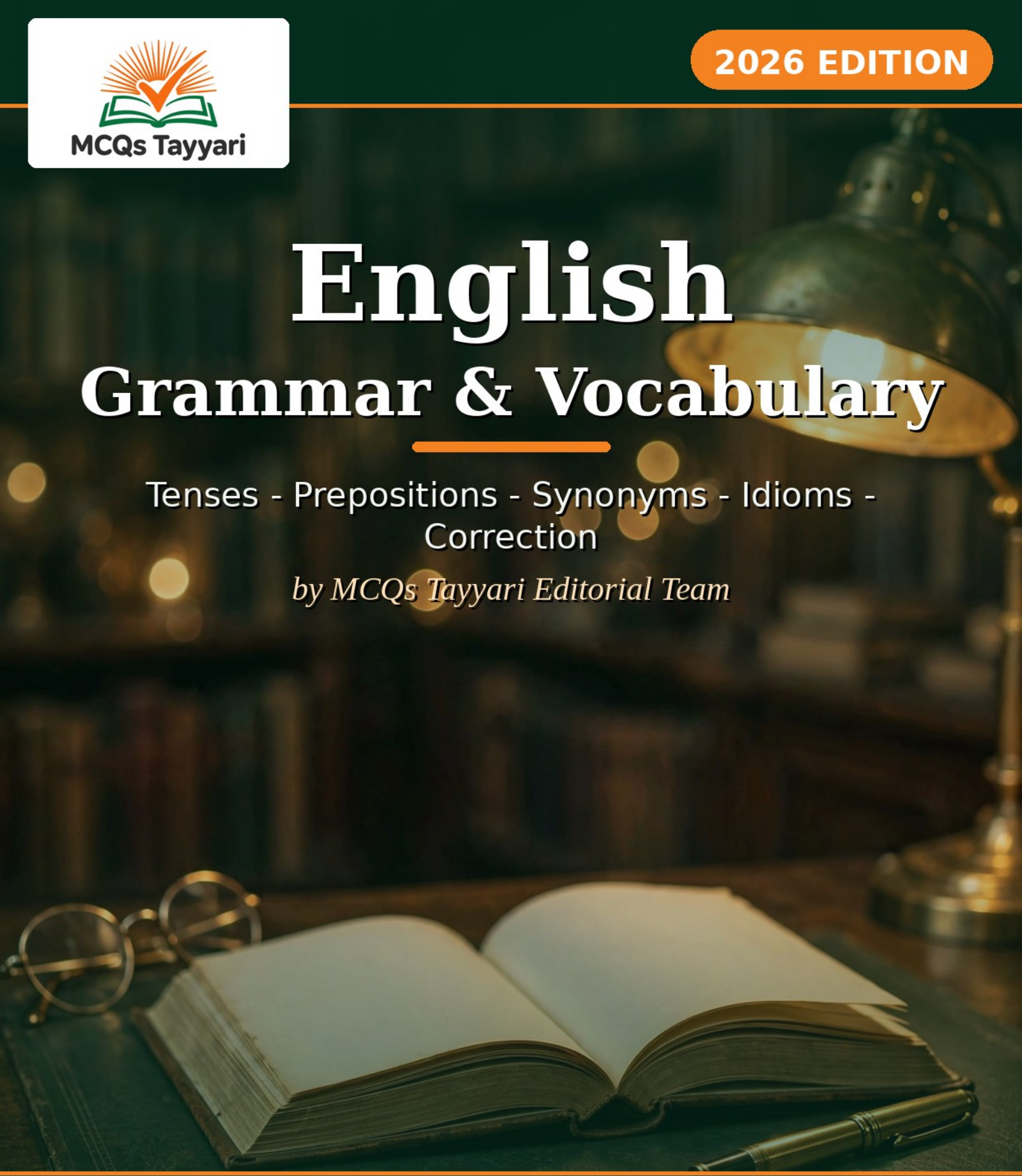
2026 EDITION

English

Grammar & Vocabulary

Tenses - Prepositions - Synonyms - Idioms - Correction

by MCQs Tayyari Editorial Team



100 ORIGINAL MCQs

With Answers & Explanations

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100 Original MCQs with Answers & Explanations

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English carries a fixed block of marks in almost every competitive exam in Pakistan. This book covers the grammar rules examiners love to trap you with — tenses, prepositions, voice, narration — plus the vocabulary that repeats year after year: synonyms, antonyms, idioms and one-word substitutions.

How to use this book

Attempt each question honestly before reading the answer printed below it. The correct option is marked in the green box, followed by a short explanation — read the explanation even when you were right, because that one line is the fact the examiner is testing. When you finish, check yourself against the answer key at the end and note the topics you missed.

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Q1. In the sentence 'The committee finally reached a unanimous decision,' the word 'unanimous' is:

A) an adjective
B) an adverb
C) a noun
D) a preposition

✓ **Answer: A) an adjective**

It describes the noun 'decision'.

Q2. Identify the adverb in: 'She spoke confidently during the interview.'

A) spoke
B) confidently
C) during
D) interview

✓ **Answer: B) confidently**

'Confidently' modifies the verb 'spoke'.

Q3. In 'Honesty is the best policy,' the word 'Honesty' functions as:

A) an adjective
B) a verb
C) a noun
D) an interjection

✓ **Answer: C) a noun**

It names a quality and works as the subject noun.

Q4. Which word is a conjunction in the sentence 'He is poor, but he is honest.'?

A) poor
B) he
C) is
D) but

✓ **Answer: D) but**

'But' joins the two clauses.

Q5. The word 'quickly' in 'The rescue team arrived quickly' is:

A) an adverb
B) an adjective
C) a verb
D) a pronoun

✓ **Answer: A) an adverb**

It modifies the verb 'arrived', telling how the action happened.

Q6. She ___ in Lahore since 2015.

A) has been living
B) lives
C) lived
D) is live

✓ **Answer: A) has been living**

'Since 2015' calls for the present perfect continuous.

Q7. By this time tomorrow, we ___ our journey.

A) will complete
B) will have completed
C) have completed
D) completed

✓ **Answer: B) will have completed**

Future perfect marks an action finished before a future point.

Q8. He usually ___ to the office by bus.

A) go
B) going
C) goes
D) gone

✓ **Answer: C) goes**

Third-person singular present simple takes -s.

Q9. I ___ my keys yesterday; I could not find them anywhere.

A) lose
B) have lost
C) am losing
D) lost

✓ **Answer: D) lost**

'Yesterday' marks a finished past action, so simple past.

Q10. While the teacher was explaining the lesson, the students ___ notes.

A) were taking
B) take
C) have taken
D) will take

✓ **Answer: A) were taking**

Past continuous shows an action in progress at a past moment.

Q11. If it rains tomorrow, the match ___.

A) will cancel
B) will be cancelled
C) is cancelled
D) cancels

✓ **Answer: B) will be cancelled**

First conditional with passive: the match receives the action.

Q12. They ___ dinner when the guests arrived.

A) have
B) had
C) were having
D) has

✓ **Answer: C) were having**

Past continuous sets the background for the past simple arrival.

Q13. Look! The baby ___.

A) cried
B) cries
C) has cried
D) is crying

✓ **Answer: D) is crying**

'Look!' signals an action happening now: present continuous.

Q14. She ___ her degree before she joined the bank.

A) completes
B) has completed
C) had completed
D) is completing

✓ **Answer: C) had completed**

Past perfect for the earlier of two past actions.

Q15. I ___ to this gym for three years before I moved abroad.

A) go
B) have gone
C) am going
D) had been going

✓ **Answer: D) had been going**

Past perfect continuous for a duration ending before another past event.

Q16. The meeting is scheduled ___ Monday morning.

A) on
B) in
C) at
D) by

✓ **Answer: A) on**

'On' is used with days of the week.

Q17. She has been suffering from fever ___ last Friday.

A) for
B) since
C) from
D) at

✓ **Answer: B) since**

'Since' marks the starting point of a period.

Q18. The cat jumped ___ the table.

A) on
B) over
C) onto
D) into

✓ **Answer: C) onto**

'Onto' shows movement to the top of a surface.

Q19. He insisted ___ paying the bill himself.

A) to
B) for
C) at
D) on

✓ **Answer: D) on**

'Insist on' is the fixed collocation.

Q20. The train arrived ___ the station ten minutes late.

A) at
B) on
C) in
D) to

✓ **Answer: A) at**

'Arrive at' is used for small places like stations.

Q21. Distribute the sweets ___ the children.

A) between
B) among
C) with
D) to

✓ **Answer: B) among**

'Among' is used for more than two people.

Q22. He was born ___ 1998.

A) on
B) at
C) in
D) from

✓ **Answer: C) in**

'In' is used with years.

Q23. She is good ___ mathematics.

A) in
B) for
C) with
D) at

✓ **Answer: D) at**

'Good at' is the fixed collocation for skills.

Q24. ___ honest man always speaks the truth.

A) An
B) A
C) The
D) No article

✓ **Answer: A) An**

'An' comes before vowel sounds; 'honest' starts with a vowel sound.

Q25. She plays ___ piano very well.

A) a
B) the
C) an
D) no article

✓ **Answer: B) the**

Musical instruments take 'the'.

Q26. I saw ___ one-eyed man at the gate.

A) an
B) the
C) a
D) no article

✓ **Answer: C) a**

'One-eyed' begins with the consonant sound /w/, so 'a'.

Q27. ___ Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.

A) A
B) An
C) The
D) No article

✓ **Answer: D) No article**

Mountain peaks take no article.

Q28. He is ___ best student in the class.

A) a
B) the
C) an
D) no article

✓ **Answer: B) the**

Superlatives take 'the'.

Q29. Neither of the answers ___ correct.

A) is
B) are
C) were
D) be

✓ **Answer: A) is**

'Neither' is singular and takes a singular verb.

Q30. The news ___ not always reliable.

A) are
B) is
C) were
D) have been

✓ **Answer: B) is**

'News' is singular in form and sense.

Q31. Each of the students ___ submitted the assignment.

A) have
B) are
C) has
D) were

✓ **Answer: C) has**

'Each' is singular; the verb agrees with it, not 'students'.

Q32. Ten kilometres ___ a long distance to walk daily.

A) are
B) were
C) have
D) is

✓ **Answer: D) is**

A measurement expressing one unit takes a singular verb.

Q33. The committee ___ divided on this issue.

A) are
B) is
C) was
D) has been

✓ **Answer: A) are**

A collective noun acting as individuals takes a plural verb.

Q34. Bread and butter ___ his favourite breakfast.

A) are
B) is
C) were
D) have

✓ **Answer: B) is**

Two nouns forming one idea take a singular verb.

Q35. Not only the students but also the teacher ___ present.

A) were
B) have
C) was
D) are

✓ **Answer: C) was**

The verb agrees with the nearer subject, 'teacher'.

Q36. The quality of these mangoes ___ excellent.

A) are
B) were
C) have
D) is

✓ **Answer: D) is**

The verb agrees with the head noun 'quality', not 'mangoes'.

Q37. Active: 'The gardener waters the plants daily.' Passive:

A) The plants are watered daily by the gardener
B) The plants were watered daily by the gardener
C) The plants have been watered daily by the gardener
D) The plants is watered daily by the gardener

✓ **Answer: A) The plants are watered daily by the gardener**

Present simple active becomes present simple passive (is/are + past participle).

Q38. Passive: 'The letter was written by Ali.' Active:

A) Ali writes the letter
B) Ali wrote the letter
C) Ali has written the letter
D) Ali is writing the letter

✓ **Answer: B) Ali wrote the letter**

'Was written' is simple past passive; the active is simple past.

Q39. Active: 'They will announce the result tomorrow.' Passive:

A) The result is announced tomorrow
B) The result was announced tomorrow
C) The result will be announced tomorrow
D) The result has been announced tomorrow

✓ **Answer: C) The result will be announced tomorrow**

'Will' becomes 'will be' + past participle in the passive.

Q40. Passive: 'The work has been completed.' Active:

A) Someone completes the work
B) Someone completed the work
C) Someone is completing the work
D) Someone has completed the work

✓ **Answer: D) Someone has completed the work**

Present perfect passive converts to present perfect active.

Q41. Active: 'She is preparing dinner.' Passive:

A) Dinner was prepared by her
B) Dinner is being prepared by her
C) Dinner has been prepared by her
D) Dinner will be prepared by her

✓ **Answer: B) Dinner is being prepared by her**

Present continuous passive uses 'is/are being' + past participle.

Q42. Passive: 'The thief was caught by the police.' Active:

A) The police catch the thief
B) The police have caught the thief
C) The police caught the thief
D) The police are catching the thief

✓ **Answer: C) The police caught the thief**

Simple past passive converts to simple past active.

Q43. Direct: He said, 'I am tired.' Indirect:

A) He said that he was tired
B) He said that he is tired
C) He said that I was tired
D) He says that he was tired

✓ **Answer: A) He said that he was tired**

Present simple shifts to past simple in reported speech.

Q44. Direct: She said, 'I will call you tomorrow.' Indirect:

A) She said that she will call me tomorrow
B) She said that she would call me the next day
C) She said that I would call her the next day
D) She says that she would call me the next day

✓ **Answer: B) She said that she would call me the next day**

'Will' becomes 'would' and 'tomorrow' becomes 'the next day'.

Q45. Direct: 'Are you coming?' he asked. Indirect:

A) He asked if I am coming
B) He asked that was I coming
C) He asked whether I was coming
D) He asked am I coming

✓ **Answer: C) He asked whether I was coming**

Yes/no questions use 'if/whether' with statement word order.

Q46. Direct: The teacher said, 'Work hard.' Indirect:

A) The teacher said to work hardly
B) The teacher told that work hard
C) The teacher said work hard
D) The teacher advised us to work hard

✓ **Answer: D) The teacher advised us to work hard**

Imperatives become infinitive constructions in reported speech.

Q47. Direct: I said to him, 'You have done well.' Indirect:

A) I told him that he had done well
B) I told him that he has done well
C) I said to him that you had done well
D) I told to him that he did well

✓ **Answer: A) I told him that he had done well**

Present perfect shifts to past perfect; 'you' becomes 'he'.

Q48. Direct: She said, 'I bought this book yesterday.' Indirect:

A) She said that she bought this book yesterday
B) She said that I had bought this book yesterday
C) She said that she has bought that book yesterday
D) She said that she had bought that book the previous day

✓ **Answer: D) She said that she had bought that book the previous day**

Past simple goes to past perfect; 'this' to 'that'; 'yesterday' to 'the previous day'.

Q49. Choose the correct sentence:

A) She prefers tea to coffee
B) She prefers tea than coffee
C) She prefers tea over coffee to
D) She is preferring tea to coffee

✓ **Answer: A) She prefers tea to coffee**

The correct structure is 'prefer X to Y'.

Q50. Choose the correct sentence:

A) He is senior than me
B) He is senior to me
C) He is more senior than me in age to
D) He is senior from me

✓ **Answer: B) He is senior to me**

'Senior' is followed by 'to', not 'than'.

Q51. Choose the correct sentence:

A) One of my friend is a doctor
B) One of my friends are doctors
C) One of my friends is a doctor
D) One of my friend are a doctor

✓ **Answer: C) One of my friends is a doctor**

'One of' takes a plural noun but a singular verb.

Q52. Choose the correct sentence:

A) I have been working here since five years
B) I am working here for five years
C) I work here since five years
D) I have been working here for five years

✓ **Answer: D) I have been working here for five years**

'For' is used with a duration of time.

Q53. Choose the correct sentence:

A) The scissors are sharp
B) The scissors is sharp
C) The scissor are sharp
D) Scissors is sharp tool

✓ **Answer: A) The scissors are sharp**

Plural-only nouns like 'scissors' take plural verbs.

Q54. Choose the correct sentence:

A) He denied to steal the money
B) He denied stealing the money
C) He denied steal the money
D) He denied to have steal the money

✓ **Answer: B) He denied stealing the money**

'Deny' is followed by a gerund, not an infinitive.

Q55. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A) Occassion
B) Ocassion
C) Occasion
D) Occasionn

✓ **Answer: C) Occasion**

'Occasion' has double c and single s.

Q56. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A) Embarass
B) Embarras
C) Embarrasse
D) Embarrass

✓ **Answer: D) Embarrass**

'Embarrass' has double r and double s.

Q57. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A) Necessary
B) Necessery
C) Neccessary
D) Neccesary

✓ **Answer: A) Necessary**

'Necessary' has one c and double s.

Q58. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A) Recieve
B) Receive
C) Riceive
D) Receeve

✓ **Answer: B) Receive**

'i before e except after c': receive.

Q59. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A) Persue
B) Pursuade
C) Pursue
D) Persuadee

✓ **Answer: C) Pursue**

'Pursue' is spelled p-u-r-s-u-e.

Q60. Choose the correctly spelt word:

A) Definately
B) Definetly
C) Definatly
D) Definitely

✓ **Answer: D) Definitely**

'Definitely' comes from 'finite': d-e-f-i-n-i-t-e-l-y.

Q61. ABANDON - closest in meaning to:

A) Desert
B) Keep
C) Arrive
D) Build

✓ **Answer: A) Desert**

'Abandon' means to leave behind completely.

Q62. CANDID - closest in meaning to:

A) Secretive
B) Frank
C) Rude
D) Timid

✓ **Answer: B) Frank**

'Candid' means truthful and straightforward.

Q63. DILIGENT - closest in meaning to:

A) Lazy
B) Careless
C) Hardworking
D) Hasty

✓ **Answer: C) Hardworking**

'Diligent' means showing care and effort in work.

Q64. TRANQUIL - closest in meaning to:

A) Noisy
B) Violent
C) Anxious
D) Peaceful

✓ **Answer: D) Peaceful**

'Tranquil' means calm and quiet.

Q65. OBSCURE - closest in meaning to:

A) Unclear
B) Famous
C) Bright
D) Simple

✓ **Answer: A) Unclear**

'Obscure' means not well known or hard to understand.

Q66. METICULOUS - closest in meaning to:

A) Careless
B) Thorough
C) Quick
D) Rough

✓ **Answer: B) Thorough**

'Meticulous' means showing great attention to detail.

Q67. VIVACIOUS - closest in meaning to:

A) Dull
B) Tired
C) Lively
D) Silent

✓ **Answer: C) Lively**

'Vivacious' means attractively lively and animated.

Q68. PRUDENT - closest in meaning to:

A) Reckless
B) Wasteful
C) Hasty
D) Wise

✓ **Answer: D) Wise**

'Prudent' means acting with care and good judgement.

Q69. RESILIENT - closest in meaning to:

A) Tough
B) Fragile
C) Rigid
D) Weak

✓ **Answer: A) Tough**

'Resilient' means able to recover quickly from difficulty.

Q70. AMBIGUOUS - closest in meaning to:

A) Clear
B) Unclear
C) Certain
D) Obvious

✓ **Answer: B) Unclear**

'Ambiguous' means open to more than one interpretation.

Q71. BENEVOLENT - closest in meaning to:

A) Cruel
B) Selfish
C) Kind
D) Greedy

✓ **Answer: C) Kind**

'Benevolent' means well-meaning and kindly.

Q72. GENEROUS - opposite in meaning to:

A) Liberal
B) Charitable
C) Kind
D) Stingy

✓ **Answer: D) Stingy**

'Stingy' means unwilling to give: the opposite of generous.

Q73. EXPAND - opposite in meaning to:

A) Extend
B) Enlarge
C) Contract
D) Stretch

✓ **Answer: C) Contract**

'Contract' means to shrink: the opposite of expand.

Q74. TRANSPARENT - opposite in meaning to:

A) Clear
B) Opaque
C) Obvious
D) Visible

✓ **Answer: B) Opaque**

'Opaque' means not letting light through: the opposite of transparent.

Q75. VICTORY - opposite in meaning to:

A) Defeat
B) Triumph
C) Success
D) Win

✓ **Answer: A) Defeat**

'Defeat' is the direct opposite of victory.

Q76. ANCIENT - opposite in meaning to:

A) Old
B) Antique
C) Aged
D) Modern

✓ **Answer: D) Modern**

'Modern' means of the present time: the opposite of ancient.

Q77. BRAVERY - opposite in meaning to:

A) Courage
B) Valour
C) Cowardice
D) Heroism

✓ **Answer: C) Cowardice**

'Cowardice' is the direct opposite of bravery.

Q78. SCARCE - opposite in meaning to:

A) Rare
B) Abundant
C) Short
D) Limited

✓ **Answer: B) Abundant**

'Abundant' means existing in large quantities: the opposite of scarce.

Q79. HUMBLE - opposite in meaning to:

A) Arrogant
B) Modest
C) Meek
D) Polite

✓ **Answer: A) Arrogant**

'Arrogant' means having excessive pride: the opposite of humble.

Q80. PERMANENT - opposite in meaning to:

A) Lasting
B) Stable
C) Eternal
D) Temporary

✓ **Answer: D) Temporary**

'Temporary' means lasting a short time: the opposite of permanent.

Q81. OPTIMISTIC - opposite in meaning to:

A) Hopeful
B) Confident
C) Pessimistic
D) Cheerful

✓ **Answer: C) Pessimistic**

'Pessimistic' means expecting the worst: the opposite of optimistic.

Q82. FRAGILE - opposite in meaning to:

A) Sturdy
B) Delicate
C) Brittle
D) Weak

✓ **Answer: A) Sturdy**

'Sturdy' means strongly built: the opposite of fragile.

Q83. A person who speaks many languages:

A) Polyglot
B) Orator
C) Miser
D) Optimist

✓ **Answer: A) Polyglot**

A polyglot knows or uses several languages.

Q84. One who does not believe in God:

A) Theist
B) Atheist
C) Agnostic
D) Heretic

✓ **Answer: B) Atheist**

An atheist denies the existence of God.

Q85. A place where birds are kept:

A) Apiary
B) Stable
C) Aviary
D) Aquarium

✓ **Answer: C) Aviary**

An aviary is a large enclosure for keeping birds.

Q86. A speech delivered without preparation:

A) Eulogy
B) Dialogue
C) Prologue
D) Extempore

✓ **Answer: D) Extempore**

'Extempore' means spoken without preparation.

Q87. One who can use both hands equally well:

A) Ambidextrous
B) Versatile
C) Expert
D) Flexible

✓ **Answer: A) Ambidextrous**

'Ambidextrous' literally means right-handed on both sides.

Q88. A person who is indifferent to pleasure and pain:

A) Hedonist
B) Stoic
C) Epicure
D) Cynic

✓ **Answer: B) Stoic**

A stoic endures hardship without complaint.

Q89. The study of the origin of words:

A) Phonetics
B) Syntax
C) Etymology
D) Morphology

✓ **Answer: C) Etymology**

Etymology traces the history and origin of words.

Q90. Government by a small group of people:

A) Democracy
B) Monarchy
C) Autocracy
D) Oligarchy

✓ **Answer: D) Oligarchy**

Oligarchy is rule by a small privileged group.

Q91. 'To bite the dust' means:

A) To fail or be defeated
B) To eat quickly
C) To work in a field
D) To hide from danger

✓ **Answer: A) To fail or be defeated**

It means to suffer defeat or failure.

Q92. 'A blessing in disguise' means:

A) A religious ceremony
B) A hidden benefit
C) A secret curse
D) An obvious favour

✓ **Answer: B) A hidden benefit**

Something that seems bad but turns out good.

Q93. 'To burn the midnight oil' means:

A) To waste fuel
B) To cook late
C) To work late into the night
D) To start a fire

✓ **Answer: C) To work late into the night**

It means studying or working late at night.

Q94. 'Once in a blue moon' means:

A) Every month
B) At night
C) During winter
D) Very rarely

✓ **Answer: D) Very rarely**

It describes something that happens very seldom.

Q95. 'To let the cat out of the bag' means:

A) To reveal a secret
B) To free an animal
C) To start a fight
D) To make a mistake

✓ **Answer: A) To reveal a secret**

It means to disclose something hidden.

Q96. 'Hit the nail on the head' means:

A) To injure oneself
B) To say exactly the right thing
C) To start construction
D) To win a prize

✓ **Answer: B) To say exactly the right thing**

It means to describe something precisely correctly.

Q97. 'A piece of cake' means:

A) A dessert
B) A small share
C) Something very easy
D) A celebration

✓ **Answer: C) Something very easy**

It describes a task that is easy to do.

Q98. 'To beat around the bush' means:

A) To win a race
B) To clear a forest
C) To attack suddenly
D) To avoid saying what you mean

✓ **Answer: D) To avoid saying what you mean**

It means to talk indirectly instead of getting to the point.

Q99. 'Under the weather' means:

A) In the rain
B) Feeling unwell
C) Under pressure
D) Outdoors

✓ **Answer: B) Feeling unwell**

It means feeling slightly ill.

Q100. 'The ball is in your court' means:

A) A tennis match
B) A lost opportunity
C) A difficult game
D) It is your turn to act

✓ **Answer: D) It is your turn to act**

It means the responsibility now lies with you.

Answer Key

All 100 answers at a glance — use it for a final self-check.

1. A	2. B	3. C	4. D	5. A
6. A	7. B	8. C	9. D	10. A
11. B	12. C	13. D	14. C	15. D
16. A	17. B	18. C	19. D	20. A
21. B	22. C	23. D	24. A	25. B
26. C	27. D	28. B	29. A	30. B
31. C	32. D	33. A	34. B	35. C
36. D	37. A	38. B	39. C	40. D
41. B	42. C	43. A	44. B	45. C
46. D	47. A	48. D	49. A	50. B
51. C	52. D	53. A	54. B	55. C
56. D	57. A	58. B	59. C	60. D
61. A	62. B	63. C	64. D	65. A
66. B	67. C	68. D	69. A	70. B
71. C	72. D	73. C	74. B	75. A
76. D	77. C	78. B	79. A	80. D
81. C	82. A	83. A	84. B	85. C
86. D	87. A	88. B	89. C	90. D
91. A	92. B	93. C	94. D	95. A
96. B	97. C	98. D	99. B	100. D

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